a FlexLifeFi K-12 program

Cash & Company

TEACHER PD · MODULE 03

The Cash Voice

Band-locked. Anti-hustle. The five-word personality core.

The fifteen phrases Cash never says, the seven canonical phrases Cash returns to, and the laminated card every teacher keeps inside their plan book.

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The Cash Voice

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> Curious. Warm. Honest. Patient. Specific.

Module length: ~20 minutes **Activities to do alongside:** Activity 5 (Voice-Band-Spotting Drill), Activity 6 (The Forbidden-Phrase Sort) **Walkaway move:** a laminated card of "Cash never says" (template at the end of this module).

Why voice matters

A curriculum's voice is not decoration. It is a load-bearing wall. The voice is what makes a Cash to Company classroom recognizable as a Cash to Company classroom whether the teacher is in Tampa or Topeka, whether the class is 6 students or 36, whether it is taught in Spanish or English. The voice is what makes the spine question land instead of bouncing off. The voice is what makes a 6-year-old and a 16-year-old experience the same character.

If you slip from the Cash voice into a hype-bro voice, the program turns into the thing it explicitly opposes. That is a bigger failure than mis-teaching contribution margin. A teacher can correct a math mistake the next day. A teacher cannot easily un-promise wealth to a 4th-grader who heard them say "anyone can be rich!" on Tuesday.

This module teaches you the voice rules with enough specificity that you can apply them under pressure — when a parent asks an aggressive question at pickup, when a student demands a hype-pep-talk before the showcase, when an admin wants you to put "transformative!" on the marketing flyer.

The personality core

Five words. Memorize them. They describe both Cash and the brand:

> **Curious. Warm. Honest. Patient. Specific.**

If a sentence you are about to say is not curious, warm, honest, patient, and specific, do not say it on behalf of the program.

The five voice principles that flow from the personality:

1. **Specific over vague.** Names actual numbers, actual ages, actual quotes, actual classrooms.
2. **Honest over hyped.** Hedges. Says "probably," "in most cases," "we expect." Never "guaranteed," "the only," "the best."
3. **Plain over corporate.** Uses the words a parent in line at a coffee shop would use. Never "leverage," "synergy," "engagement-driver."
4. **Question-led over declaration-led.** When in doubt about a headline or a transition, end on a question.

5. **The student is the protagonist.** The kid is the hero. The teacher is the partner. The parent is the witness. Cash is the guide.

Voice across the four bands

Cash adjusts vocabulary and pacing across grade bands. The personality and core question never change. What changes is the words.

K-2 CASH

- **Sentence length:** 6–10 words.
- **Vocabulary:** coins, snacks, helpers, jobs, store, sign, money. Concrete only.
- **No abstractions.** No "evidence" — instead, "what did you see?"
- **Repetition is friendly.** Cash repeats key words: "notice, notice, notice."
- **Sample line:** "What did the helper do? Tell me what you saw with your eyes."

3-5 CASH

- **Sentence length:** 10–15 words.
- **Vocabulary:** customer, problem, plan, profit, price, cost.
- **Cash starts asking "what's your evidence" — but in plain words:** "how do you know that?"
- **Sample line:** "You picked this idea. How do you know somebody actually wants it?"

6-8 CASH

- **Sentence length:** Full sentences, occasional complex ones.
- **Vocabulary:** customer, persona, contribution margin, A/B test, signal vs. noise.
- **Cash uses honest, slightly irreverent asides.** "Most adults skip this. You won't."
- **Cash names its own uncertainty.** "I don't know either. That's why we test."
- **Sample line:** "Revenue is loud. Contribution margin is true. Compute one number this week."

9-12 CASH

- **Sentence length:** Full-shaped arguments — Cash can build a 5-sentence point.
- **Vocabulary:** unit economics, runway, premortem, segmentation, MVP, equity, compliance.
- **Cash gets philosophical, carefully.** "You can pick what kind of business you build. It's a choice."
- **Cash names systemic factors honestly when relevant.** "Some of this is hard because the world's hard. The skill is knowing what's in your hands."
- **Sample line:** "You'll meet adults who skipped this part and got lucky. Don't model your career on luck. Model it on the moves."

WHAT IS CONSISTENT ACROSS ALL FOUR BANDS

Feature	All bands
Energy	thoughtful older sibling — never TV presenter
Tone	warm but not gushing
Mode	question-pointing
Hedging	"probably," "in most cases," "we expect"
Posture	the student is the protagonist
Ban	flattery, hype, moralizing, promising, pretending the world is fair

A voice slip across a band is bad — saying "contribution margin" to a kindergartener, saying "tell me what you saw with your eyes" to an 11th-grader. But a slip across the consistency rules is worse — saying "great job, you're going to crush it!" to anyone, in any band, ever.

The 15 phrases Cash never says

Print this list. Hand a copy to every guest speaker, every co-teacher, every substitute, every parent volunteer who shows up at Family Visit Day.

#	Phrase	Why it's banned
1	"Amazing!" / "Awesome!"	Empty flattery; the brand never gushes
2	"Boss up" / "Get that bag" / "Crush it"	Hustle-bro coded
3	"Everyone can be rich" / "Anyone can do it"	Promises wealth
4	"Easy money" / "Passive income"	False ease
5	"Just believe" / "Manifest"	Mindset-substitutes-for-evidence
6	"Side hustle"	Replace with "side venture" or "small business"
7	"Financial freedom"	Vague, hustle-bro coded
8	"Rise and grind"	Performance of work, not work itself
9	"If they can, you can"	Survivorship-bias claim
10	"When you're rich..." / future-tense wealth statements	Promises an outcome we don't promise
11	"Game-changer" / "Disruptive"	Marketing cliché

#	Phrase	Why it's banned
12	"Unleash your potential"	Self-help cliché; vague
13	"Game-ify your life"	Trivializes work
14	"Be your own boss"	Promises an outcome and a personality type
15	"Hack" (as in "money hack")	Implies a shortcut that doesn't exist

The test: if a sentence could appear word-for-word on a hustle-bro TikTok account, the brand cannot say it. Period.

Cost-positioning language Cash never uses

The whole program — its videos, its docs, its PD, its merch — is **never** described to teachers, parents, admins, funders, or partners using cost-status language. Not "free." Not "paid." Not "low-cost." Not "complimentary." We don't describe the whole program's price at all. We describe what it is and what it does.

The one carve-out: a **teaser, sample, or preview** of the program may be described as "free." A free preview lesson, a free sample chapter, a free starter Capstone pack — those are fine. The whole program is not.

A second carve-out: **named external tools** in curriculum content. "Google Sheets — as of April 2026, free with a Google account (sheets.google.com)." That is curriculum content describing the real world, not positioning Cash.

Why this matters for you, the teacher: when you describe the program in your own words — to a colleague, to a parent, to a student, on a flyer, in a faculty meeting — replace any cost-language with a substantive differentiator:

- "K-12 mascot continuity" — one Cash, thirteen years.
- "Capstone every year" — one project per grade, defended.
- "Equity-by-design" — built to land in any classroom.
- "No sponsor, no ads, no monetization of students."
- "Evidence-based pedagogy."

If you find yourself wanting to say "and it's free," catch the impulse and substitute one of the above. The program's value doesn't depend on its price tag.

Cash's go-to verbs

These are the verbs Cash uses when prompting students. Use them in your conferring.

> **Notice. Ask. Listen. Test. Check. Try. Revise. Decide. Specify. Name.**

Compare those to verbs Cash does NOT use:

> ~~Crush. Smash. Dominate. Win. Beat. Hustle. Hack. Master. Conquer.~~

The Cash verbs are slow, patient, evidence-pointing. The non-Cash verbs are aggressive, totalizing, outcome-promising. The choice between the two is a values choice that shows up in every sentence.

Cash's go-to question stems

These are the seven you should be able to deploy without thinking. Practice them in the activities.

- "Which people, and how do you know?"
- "What did they actually say?"
- "What does your evidence tell you?"
- "What would have to be true for you to be right?"
- "What would have to be true for you to be wrong?"
- "What's one thing you'd change?"
- "How would you know if you were getting better?"

The seven canonical phrases (memorize these)

These are the brand's spine sentences. Use one of them when you need an anchor for a deck slide, a parent newsletter, a Capstone Defense closer, or a hallway conversation.

1. "Which people, and how do you know?" (the opening question)
2. "Being wrong on Day 1 is the deal." (the Day 1 frame)
3. "Revenue is loud. Contribution margin is true." (the math frame)
4. "Honest claims build customers who come back. Tricks build customers who feel taken." (the messaging frame)
5. "Listening is not a moment. It's a system." (the feedback frame)
6. "A little less wrong, every week." (the growth frame)
7. "Don't sell. Show." (the closing frame)

These are quotable, t-shirt-able, headline-able. When a piece of copy needs an anchor, work one in.

The four common voice failure modes

When you slip, you usually slip in one of four directions. Catch yourself early.

1. The hype-bro. "BOSS UP! GET THAT BAG!" — Cash is not this. Ever. If you're tempted to celebrate a kid's win with hype-language, swap to specifics: "You named two customers, and you got both of their reactions on paper. That's exactly the move."

2. The overly cute mascot. Singing dollar signs, "money mountain," "savings sloth." Cash is not this. The brand is substance, not adorability. If a colleague suggests a cute character substitution, redirect to Cash.

3. The corporate trainer. "Today we will be exploring the concept of contribution margin." — Cash is warmer and more specific than this. If a script feels stiff, add a story.

4. The lecturing parent. "When I was your age, I had to walk to school in the snow." — Cash never moralizes. Cash never compares generations. If you find yourself starting a sentence with "in my day," stop.

The voice review checklist (apply to anything you write or say on behalf of the program)

- [ ] Does this contain any of the 15 banned phrases or close paraphrases?
- [ ] Does this hedge appropriately? (No "guaranteed," "always," "the best," "the only," "everyone.")
- [ ] Does this name a number, a name, or a quote? (Specific over vague.)
- [ ] Does this end on a question or anchor on a canonical phrase?
- [ ] Does this position the kid / teacher / parent as the protagonist?
- [ ] Is the audience-tone calibration right for the band you're addressing?
- [ ] Does this respect the Sensitivity Policy? (No family-money probing, no guaranteed-outcome claims, no political content.)
- [ ] If this got clipped 3 seconds out of context onto a hostile TikTok account, would it still be on-brand?

If any answer is no, revise.

Your laminated "Cash Never Says" card (template)

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CASH NEVER SAYS                    cash to company

  Amazing!     Boss up.     Easy money.
  Just believe.    Side hustle.    Manifest.
  Financial freedom.   Rise and grind.
  Game-changer.    Be your own boss.
  When you're rich...   Hack.
  If they can, you can.   Crush it.
  Everyone can be rich.

CASH ALWAYS ASKS:
Which people, and how do you know?

CASH'S VERBS:
Notice. Ask. Listen. Test. Check.
Try. Revise. Decide. Specify. Name.
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Print at 5×7. Laminate. Tape inside your plan book. Put one on the fridge in the teacher lounge.

Module 03 knowledge check

1. State the personality core in five words.
2. What's the band-locked sentence-length range for K-2 Cash?
3. Name three of the 15 banned phrases.
4. Name two of the seven canonical phrases.

Activity tie-ins

- **Activity 5 (Voice-Band-Spotting Drill):** Read 12 sample sentences. Sort them into K-2 / 3-5 / 6-8 / 9-12 / Not-Cash. Compare with answer key.
- **Activity 6 (The Forbidden-Phrase Sort):** Read 20 sample sentences. Mark the ones that contain a banned phrase or a banned cost-positioning word. Rewrite each one.

Module 03 — answers to the knowledge check

1. Curious. Warm. Honest. Patient. Specific.
2. 6–10 words.
3. Any three from: Amazing!, Boss up, Get that bag, Crush it, Everyone can be rich, Easy money, Passive income, Just believe, Manifest, Side hustle, Financial freedom, Rise and grind, If they can, you can, When you're rich, Game-changer, Disruptive, Unleash your potential, Game-ify your life, Be your own boss, Hack.

4. Any two: Which people and how do you know? / Being wrong on Day 1 is the deal / Revenue is loud, contribution margin is true / Honest claims build customers who come back / Listening is a system / A little less wrong every week / Don't sell, show.

One promise.

Curious. Warm. Honest. Patient. Specific.

Cash to Company is built so a curriculum coordinator, a foundation officer, a parent, or a teacher can pick up any one of these strategic references and meet the program at full strength on the first page.

No promise of wealth. No probing of family finances. No partisan content. One question, asked patiently for thirteen years: which people, and how do you know?

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